

WIRESHARK INSTALLATION ON WINDOWS

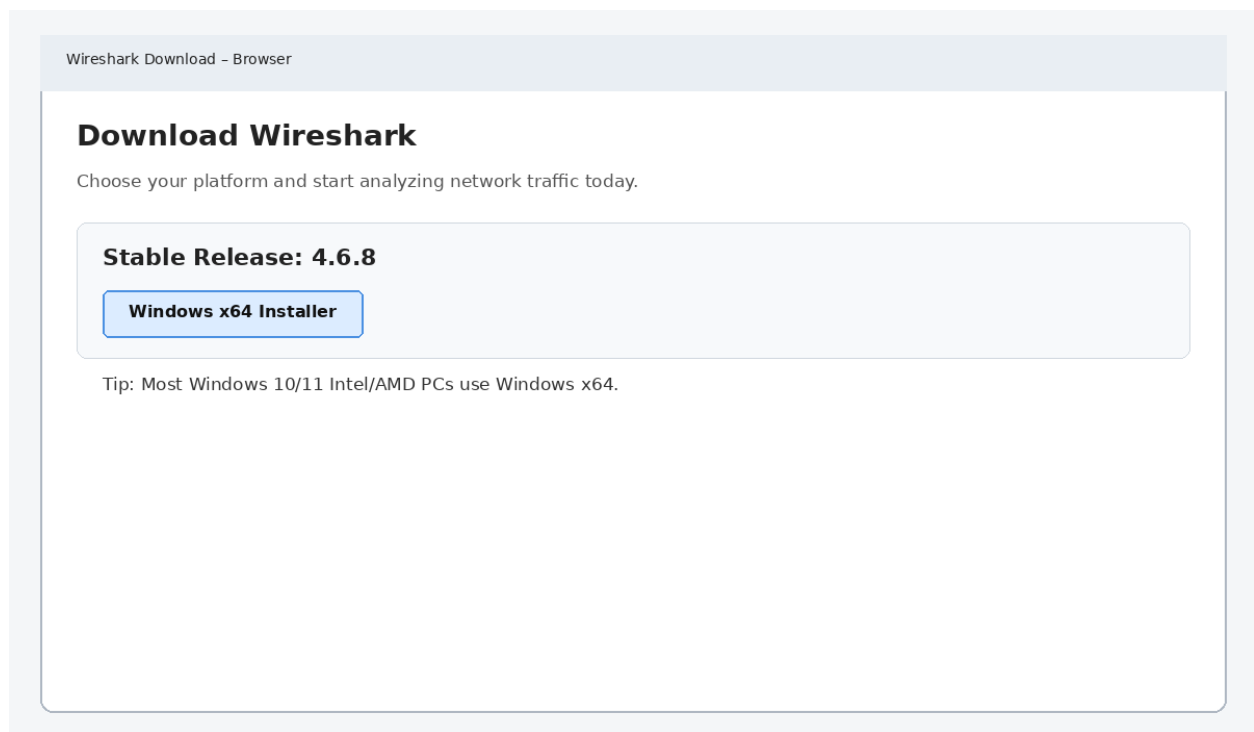
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

With picture references • Windows 10/11

Important: The exact screens can look slightly different depending on the Wireshark version. The current official download page lists Wireshark 4.6.8 as the stable release. The official Windows installer includes Npcap, which is required for live packet capture.

STEP 1 – Open the official Wireshark download page

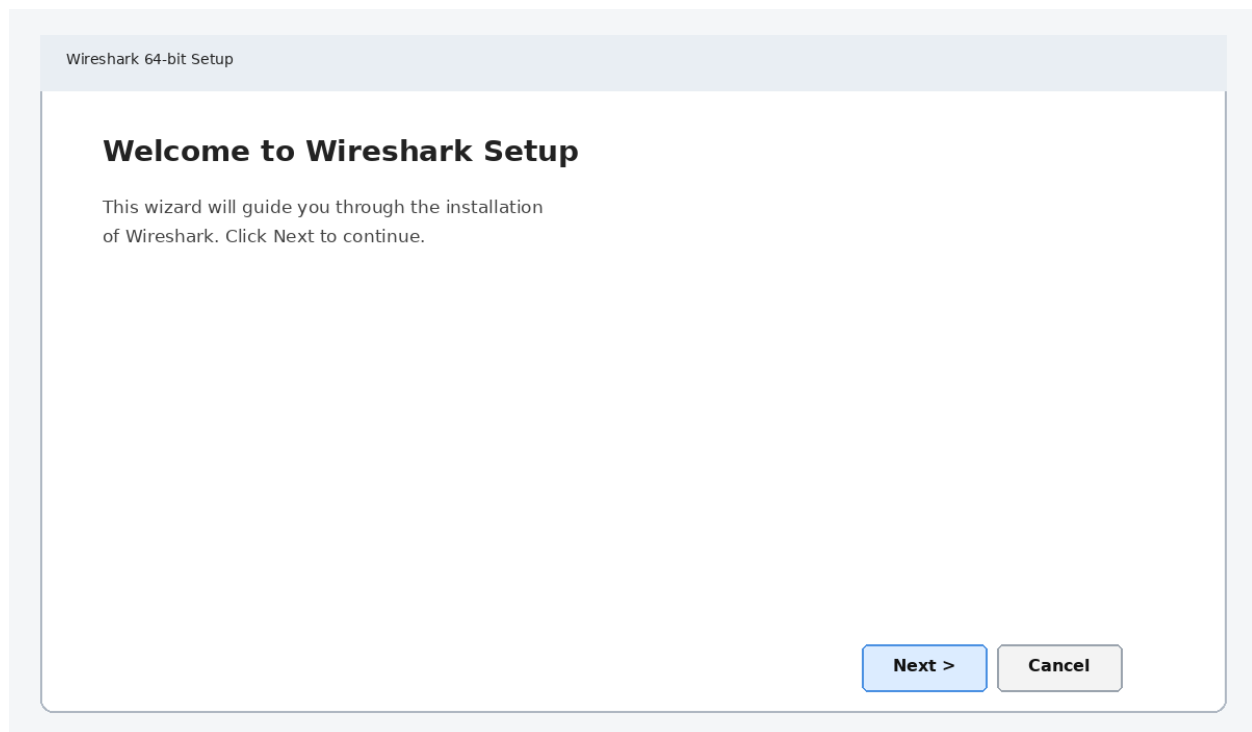
Open your browser and go to the official Wireshark download page. Select “Windows x64 Installer” for most Intel/AMD Windows PCs. Download the .exe installer.



Picture reference: Step 1 – Open the official Wireshark download page

STEP 2 – Start the installer

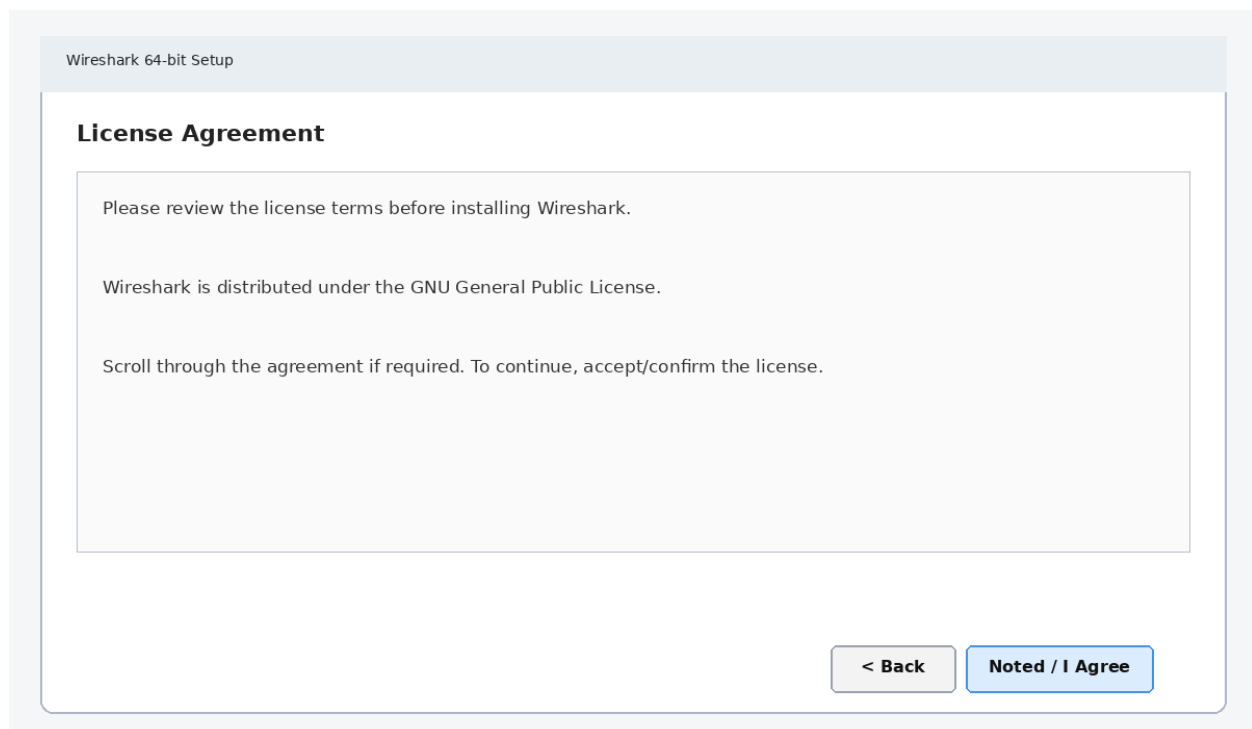
Open the downloaded Wireshark .exe file. If Windows shows a User Account Control message, click Yes. When the setup wizard appears, click Next.



Picture reference: Step 2 – Start the installer

STEP 3 – Accept/confirm the license

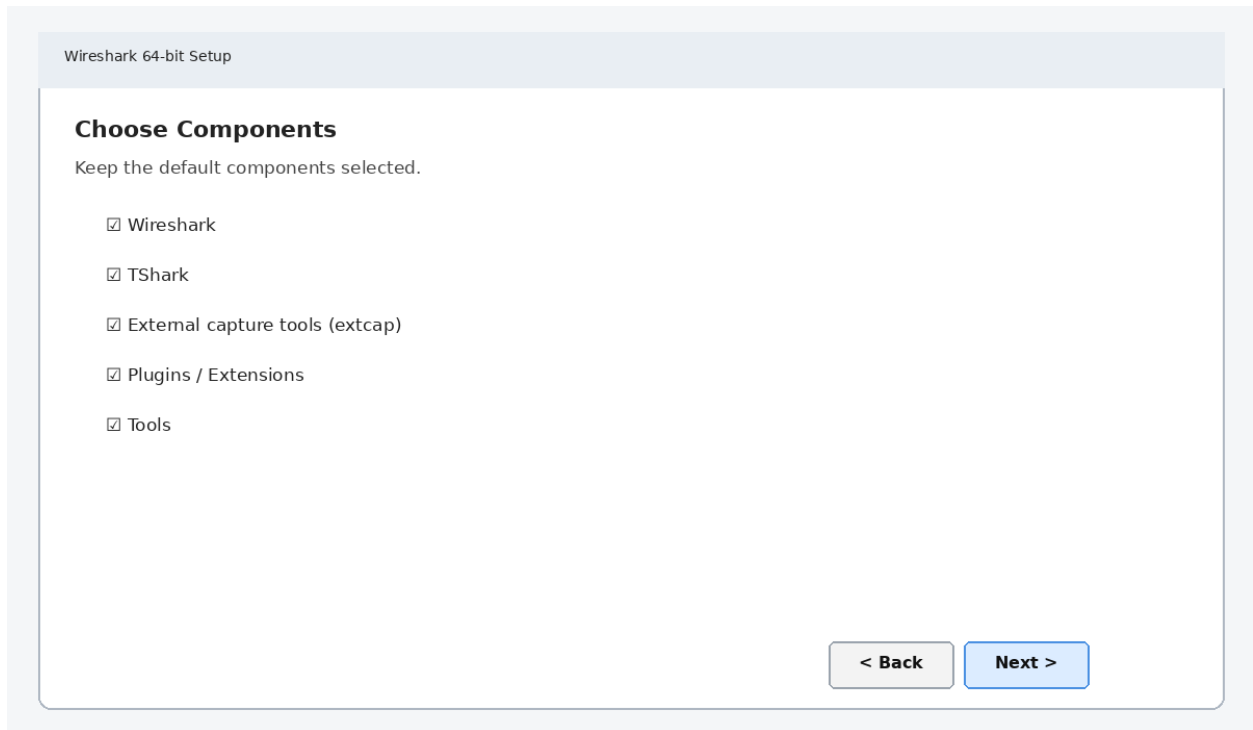
Read the license screen and click the button that accepts/confirms the agreement (the exact button text can vary by version, such as “I Agree” or “Noted”).



Picture reference: Step 3 – Accept/confirm the license

STEP 4 – Choose components

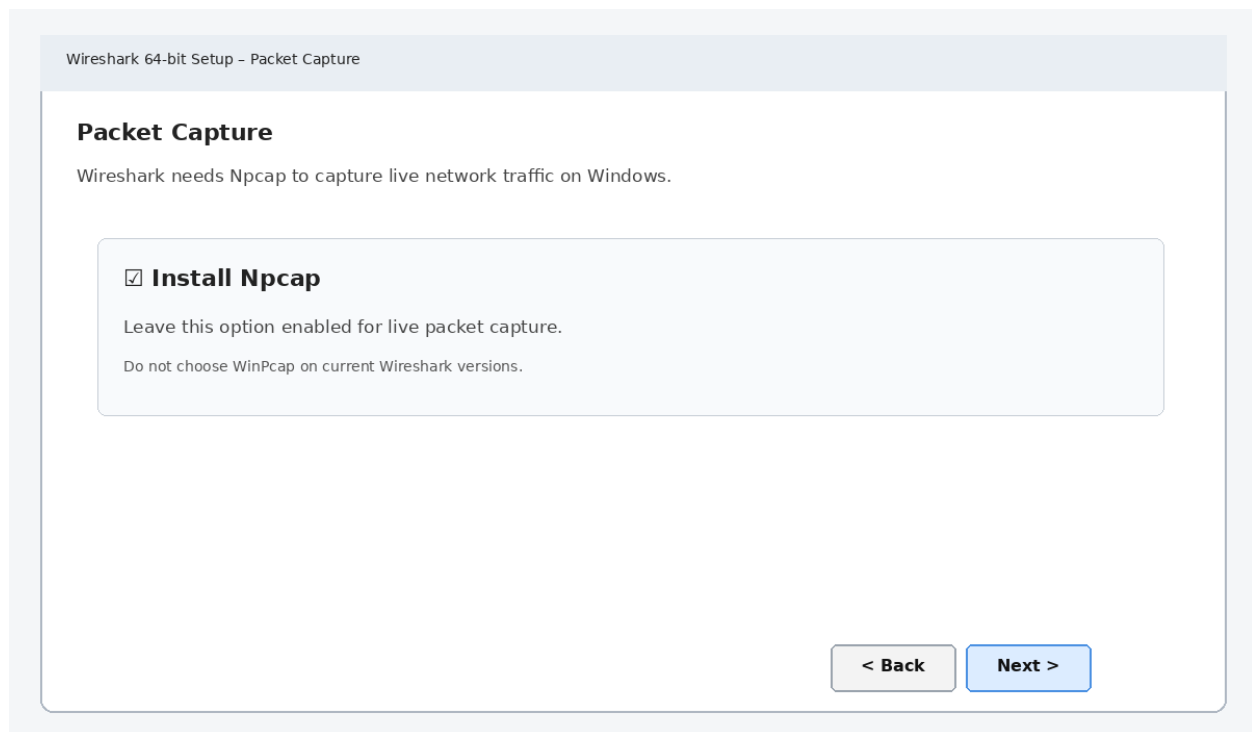
Keep the default components selected and click Next. TShark is the command-line version of Wireshark, so keeping it installed is useful for practical work.



Picture reference: Step 4 – Choose components

STEP 5 – Install Npcap

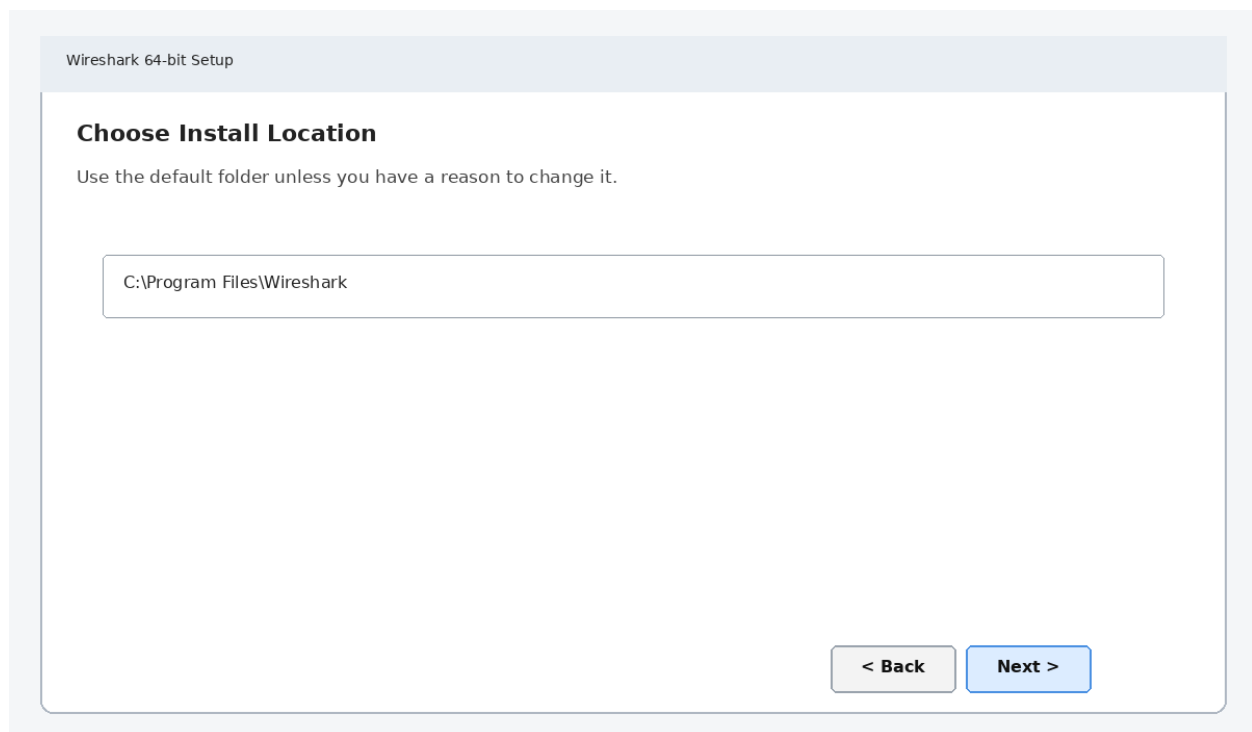
Make sure the Npcap installation option is enabled. Npcap is needed for live packet capture on Windows. Click Next. Current Wireshark versions use Npcap rather than the old WinPcap.



Picture reference: Step 5 – Install Npcap

STEP 6 – Choose the installation folder

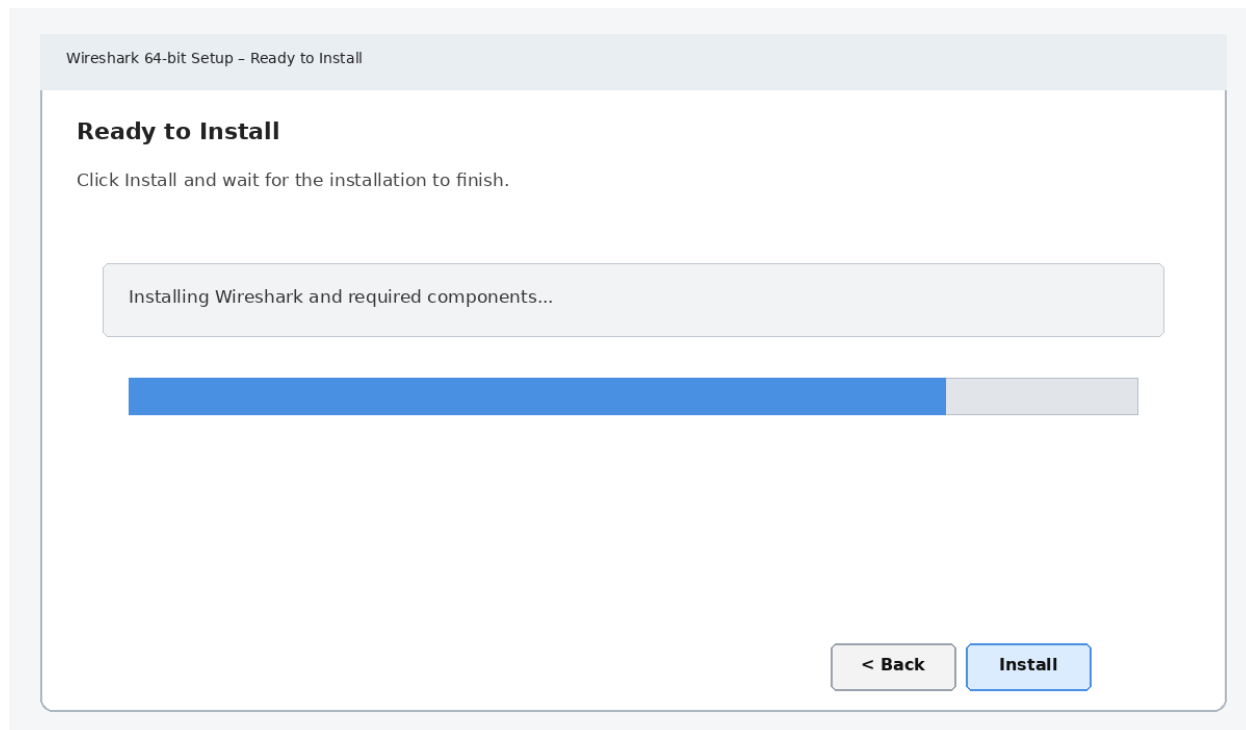
Usually, keep the default location such as C:\Program Files\Wireshark and click Next.



Picture reference: Step 6 – Choose the installation folder

STEP 7 – Install Wireshark

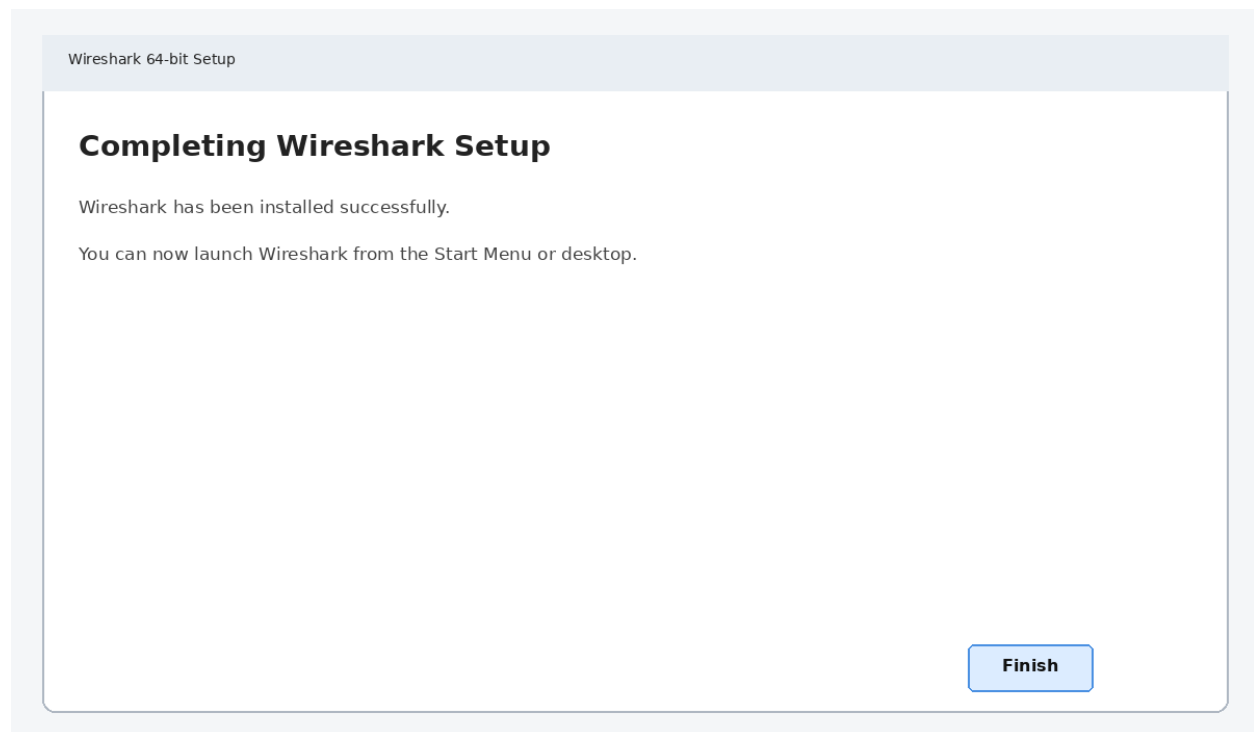
Click Install. Wait while Wireshark and its required components are installed. Do not close the setup window during installation.



Picture reference: Step 7 – Install Wireshark

STEP 8 – Finish installation

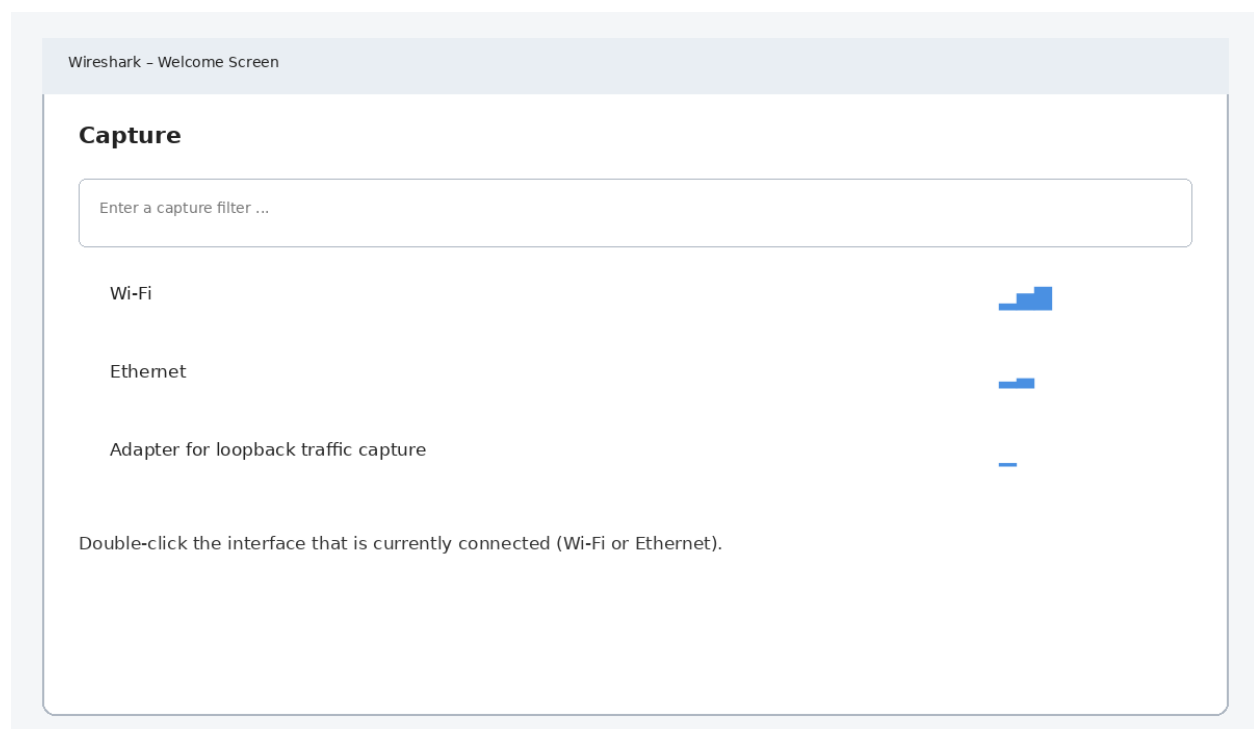
When setup reports that Wireshark has been installed successfully, click Finish. If there is an option to launch Wireshark, you can leave it selected.



Picture reference: Step 8 – Finish installation

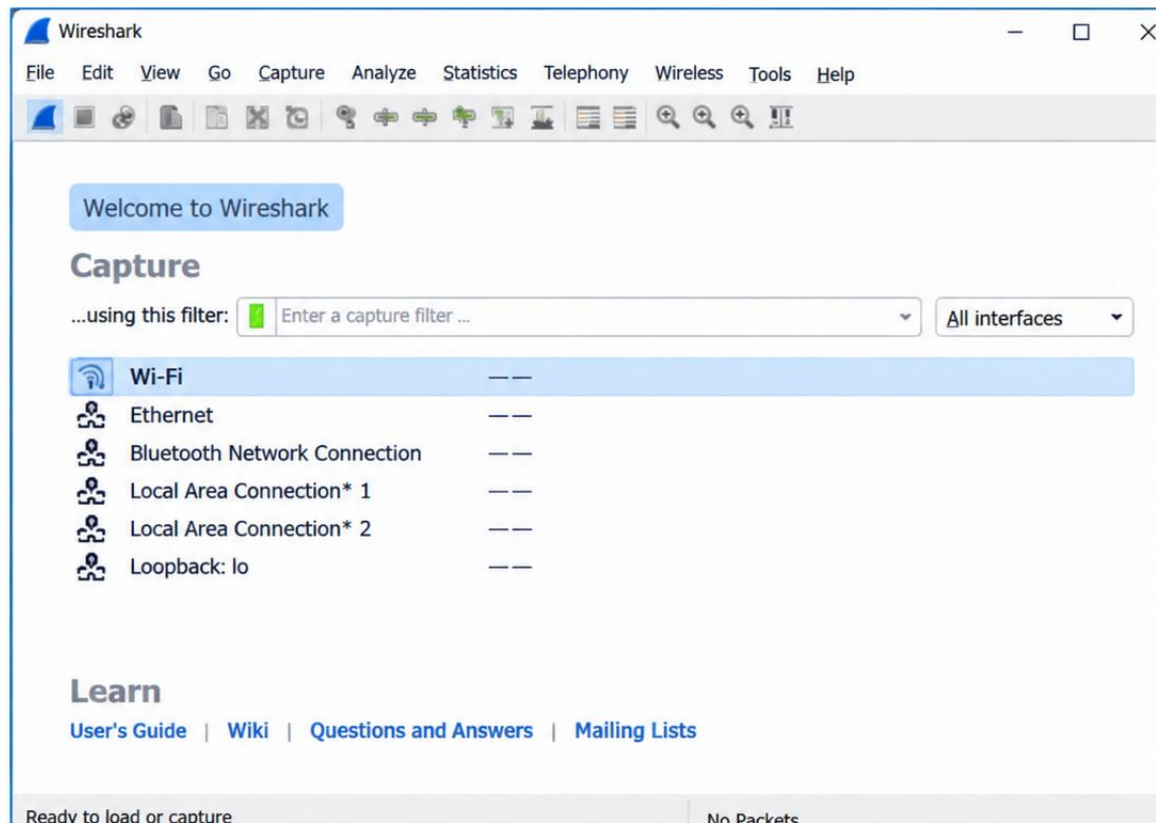
STEP 9 – Open Wireshark and select the network interface

Wireshark opens to its Welcome screen. You will see interfaces such as Wi-Fi or Ethernet. Choose the interface that is currently connected. Double-click it to begin capturing packets.



Picture reference: Step 9 – Open Wireshark and select the network interface

Wireshark – Welcome screen (Step 9)



After installation – quick test

- Open Wireshark.
- Double-click Wi-Fi or Ethernet.
- Open a website in your browser for a few seconds.
- You should see packets appearing in the packet list.
- Click the red Stop button to stop the capture.

Official source

Wireshark official download page: <https://www.wireshark.org/download.html>

The official User's Guide confirms that the Windows installer includes Npcap and that Npcap is required for live packet capture.